



NEWHALL COUNTY WATER DISTRICT WATER LINES

www.ncwd.org

Winter 2016-2017

Key Benefits of a New Water District

\$14 million in
savings in first 10
years

Opportunity to build
more regionally
beneficial projects

Directly elected
board of directors

Ends years of costly
litigation

What a New Water District Means for You

Tuesday, December 13, 2016 was a historic night for Newhall County Water District (NCWD). Amidst ongoing drought and new state water mandates, our Board of Directors joined with other regional water leaders to form a new water district for the Santa Clarita Valley.

The key benefits for customers include:

- * \$14 million in savings over the first 10 years
- * Greater economies of scale to improve reliability
- * Building of more regionally beneficial projects, like recycled water systems
- * Directly elected regional board of directors
- * Integration of a current patchwork of water systems across the Valley

We understand that change can bring questions. So we've listed a few important answers below so you know what a new district means for you.

Will my water rate be impacted?

Not by the formation of a new district. The potential \$14 million savings will minimize the impact of external factors - like general rising energy and water costs - to delay cost increases. NCWD customers can expect the same rate structure for the foreseeable future.

Will my customer service be impacted?

No. Customers can expect the same high level of service they are used to.

What would change for me?

Not much would change from your day-to-day water and customer

service. But the new district will be better positioned to increase local water reliability by building important projects, like recycled water systems. This will secure our water supply and help us control our own destiny during ongoing drought. The \$14 million in savings will also help minimize external factors that impact rates.

Are there challenges to a new district?

Change can bring challenges. We've heard a desire from the public to move slowly and methodically as to not disrupt current service.

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We've also heard a desire to protect customers from the debt of other water districts involved in the new entity. So we've built firewalls that would keep accounting separate and fair.

When will the new district be formed?

While the Board of Directors has voted to approve the new district, legislation is needed to officially form the new entity. Legislation could be approved this year and a new district would officially form on January 1, 2018.

NCWD is excited about our future and appreciates your engagement, questions and patience during the process to build a new water district for the region.

Please call NCWD's general manager at (661) 259-3610 should you have any questions. You can also visit www.YourSCVWater.com for more information, including financial analysis, customer opinion research, operational assessments and other details.

As Part of the New District, NCWD Ends Years of Costly Litigation

As part of the new water district, NCWD agreed to end years of costly litigation with Castaic Lake Water Agency. The litigation stemmed from concerns about regional water governance.

Instead of battling in courtrooms, NCWD's Board of Directors believed in a more positive, "big picture" solution - one that would address past concerns while also creating

long-term protections and benefits for customers.

The settlement agreement ensures that a new district will include strong ratepayer protections, including hiring an independent ratepayer advocate, supermajority vote requirements on financial items and a directly elected board of directors.

More information on the settlement agreement and new district can be found at www.YourSCVWater.com.

Update Your iConserve Mobile App!

NCWD's iConserve mobile app has a brand new version to download!

This app continues to help our customers save water everyday. Improvements include enhanced graphics and user-friendly menus, more functional "mobile app bill pay", and enhanced conservation reporting.

The app is a multi-functional digital tool that empowers customers with information and technology to help save water during this historic drought and beyond.

Download it from the app store or Google Play today!

GO GREEN SAVE MONEY

1. Pay your bill online with the click of a button from your home or office.
2. Sign up to receive a monthly eBill notification.
3. Visit www.ncwd.org and sign up today or contact 661-259-3610. By going "green" you're helping to protect the environment and saving money in the process.



Board of Directors

Maria Gutzeit
President

BJ Atkins
Vice-President

Kathy Colley
Director

Dan Mortensen
Director

Lynne Plambeck
Director

Meetings are regularly held at 6:30 pm on the second Thursday of the month, unless noted otherwise. The boardroom is located at 23780 North Pine Street Santa Clarita, CA

Serving Our Customers

NCWD's customer service staff is available to assist you during regular business hours, Monday through Thursday from 8 am to 5 pm and Friday from 8 am to 4 pm (except Holidays). If you have a water emergency after hours, contact NCWD 24-hours a day at (661) 259-3610 and press "0", our answering service will contact our stand-by staff member to assist you promptly.

Receive our quarterly eNewsletter directly in your inbox - Sign Up Today at www.ncwd.org

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Employee of the Year



Joshua Jenkins

Josh has worked for the District since Jan 4, 1999 starting in the Field Customer Service Department including working with the construction crew and water quality. In Jan 2016, he was promoted to Water Operations Supervisor. He is well respected by his peers, takes pride in his work and always puts the District first.